



Single room
The smaller room of the suite allotted to a *contubernium* was either a living area or the space where the soldiers stored their military equipment.

Board game
Soldiers are known to have whiled away off-duty hours with a variety of board games played with dice and counters.





Food and drink
The officers and men seem to have enjoyed a reasonably varied diet based on bread and locally produced meat, vegetables, and fruit. Luxuries shipped in *amphorae* from Spain and Italy included wine, olive oil, and *garum* (a fermented fish sauce that the Romans used to add flavour to food).



Courtyard of the house
The house was arranged around an open courtyard, which may have contained fountains. Courtyard walls are likely to have been decorated with garden scenes. The principal rooms led off a colonnaded walkway.

COMMANDING OFFICER'S HOUSE

In dramatic contrast to the privations of barrack-room life, the commanding officer of the fort was provided with a comfortable house. Since the Romans took their domestic architectural styles wherever they went, the building would have mimicked a typical Mediterranean town house, complete with dining rooms, bedrooms, a kitchen, stables, and its own hypocaust (under-floor heating system). No concessions were made to the local climate, and these airy houses built around an open central courtyard may not have been so appealing during mid-winter in the northern reaches of the empire.

Commanding officer's bedroom
Unlike the sleeping quarters in the barracks, the bedrooms in the house were spacious and kept warm by the hypocaust. Both the furniture and decoration reflect contemporary taste in Rome. The beds were richly carved and sometimes painted.

